

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Should We Eat Ultra-Processed Food?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	Ultra-processed food is described as food containing _____.
2	Examples include additives and _____.
3	These foods have been connected with _____.
4	One sign is that the food may contain five or more _____.
5	Ingredient labels may include substances such as _____, preservatives, additives, dyes and sweeteners.
6	A major reason for the popularity of ultra-processed food is _____.
7	A _____ can be put in the microwave and heated very quickly.
8	By contrast, cooking a _____ from the beginning may take much longer.
9	Chocolate, biscuits or cake may be called a _____ when someone enjoys them but feels they should not.
10	The suggested approach is not panic, but eating everything in _____.

11 **How is ultra-processed food initially characterised?**

- A It contains artificial ingredients such as additives or sweeteners.
- B It is always cooked in restaurants before being sold.
- C It contains only natural ingredients prepared at home.
- D It is mainly food that has lost its original flavour.

12 **What health concern is raised about ultra-processed foods?**

- A They make people dislike fresh food immediately.
- B They are dangerous only when eaten at breakfast.
- C They have been associated with poor health and diseases such as obesity and diabetes.
- D They mainly cause problems because they are difficult to digest.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **Which feature helps identify an ultra-processed food according to the reporter?**
- A It is served cold and needs no preparation.
 - B It is made with exactly three ingredients.
 - C It is sold only in large supermarkets.
 - D It includes several ingredients not normally found in an average kitchen.
- 14 **Why do the speakers say they now try to cook more themselves?**
- A They want to copy restaurant-style ready meals.
 - B They want more control over what goes into their food.
 - C They believe snacks are always more expensive than meals.
 - D They think chocolate should be eaten only during programmes.
- 15 **Why are ready meals used to explain the popularity of ultra-processed food?**
- A They show how quickly convenient food can be prepared.
 - B They prove processed food is usually healthier than fresh food.
 - C They show that microwave meals require advanced cooking skills.
 - D They explain why people no longer enjoy hot food.
- 16 **What does Annabel's "guilty pleasure" example show?**
- A She believes sweet foods should be banned completely.
 - B She eats chocolate only because it is cheap and convenient.
 - C She enjoys some processed treats despite feeling she probably should not.
 - D She thinks biscuits and cake are healthier than ready meals.
- 17 **How are ready meals contrasted with cooking from scratch?**
- A Ready meals require more preparation but taste fresher.
 - B Cooking from scratch is described as faster but less reliable.
 - C Both methods are said to take the same amount of time.
 - D Ready meals are quicker, while cooking from scratch takes longer.
- 18 **Why is ultra-processed food described as a tricky topic?**
- A Experts cannot identify which foods are processed.
 - B It involves a trade-off between health concerns and practical appeal.
 - C People agree that processed food tastes bad but is healthy.
 - D It is difficult because processed food is rare in daily life.

- 19 **What is the purpose of Hannah's question about crisps?**
- A To ask whether occasional enjoyment is acceptable or complete avoidance is needed.
 - B To prove that crisps are the healthiest ultra-processed snack.
 - C To argue that people should eat crisps every day.
 - D To compare crisps with fizzy drinks historically.

- 20 **What final advice is given about eating ultra-processed foods?**
- A Avoid every processed product immediately.
 - B Eat processed snacks whenever they are cheap.
 - C Stay calm and avoid having too much of anything.
 - D Replace all home-cooked meals with ready meals.